

A BELLYFUL EXPERIENCE

Woody Allen once quoted, “*There are worse things in life than death. Have you ever spent an evening with an insurance salesman?*” I’m guessing he never met entrepreneurs at a networking event.

At an event, everyone is the CEO of something and whatever they’re building is the contemporary Minimum Viable Product (MVP) in their genre. A growth that rivals a meticulously embossed hockey stick is a certainty. And if an under-prepared layman comes into the room, he is destined to walk out with quotes from Lean Startup, Zero to One or Dan Ariely.

Yes, we all get it:

- The ‘*what’s the scene bruh*’ Bangalore.
- The countless Rashmi Bansal books and its perennial knockoffs.
- The ‘*tu beer hein b\$`%^&@/!*’ inspiration.
- The ‘*OMG, I raised another round*’ piece on Yourstory.
- The incessant talks about how awesome life is, because you braved Anu aunty and decided to ‘*not think, just do.*’

A neuter look and it seemed like a new graduate who wasn’t willing to go down the entrepreneurial route was low-balling his life. Winding the clock a little, I tried to find any good reason for this tectonic shift in people’s thinking. The longer I tried to find answers, the more extended the fad had become. **As the months grew, the number of people with a sense of ‘calling in life’ grew exponentially. This led to people withdrawing from their corporate roles and moving into entrepreneurialism.** Quite often it looked like the 1920’s New York scene. Prior to the 20’s, people produced goods just in time for survival. Any surplus would be stored for drought seasons. The concept of production surplus coincided with the industrial revolution and for the first time ever, man had to find ways to make people consume against their wishes. Enter Madison Avenue money, creating new desires in order to increase consumption. As time progressed and production evolved, we started living in an age of aura. An aura that entails the belief, “*I could never live in a city without an H&M store.*”

The fascination with this aura is that: the more reclusive the idea, the more it spreads wildly. With reclusive ideas propelling them, Pepsodent, Burberry and Nike became multinationals by creating a demand that didn’t exist before the company was found. In certain terms, when we find the reasons and motivations for the things we do, there is a